

Area of Study 4: Traditions and Innovation 5.4.4

The Areas of Study define a wide background of knowledge and understanding of music and its context in different traditions, and require close, in-depth study of relevant repertoire.

5.1 COMPONENT 1 – COURSEWORK

5.1.1 Part A: Integrated Coursework

Performance 1, Composition 1 and Appraisals

Area of Study 1 (*Exploiting the Resource*) provides the main focus of learning in this part of the candidate's coursework. It is designed to build upon the instrument-specific skills developed in the National Curriculum and gives the candidate a purposeful focus for their performing studies. They should be encouraged to understand the nature and principal characteristics of their instrument/voice, to learn more about performing on it through relevant listening, and to explore its repertoire more widely than they are able to do through their own performances alone.

With guidance from the teacher, candidates will be expected to choose a 'genre' on which to base their assessed work; this may be music with a common form, style or purpose, or may simply be music which use the same resources e.g. two recorders and piano. They will be required to refer in their appraisals to three pieces in the selected genre, although only one of these need be performed for assessment in this part of the coursework.

The piece chosen for performance should both enable the candidate to demonstrate technical control, expression, and interpretation, and offer scope, as a representative of the genre studied, for the candidate to show an understanding of typical features of their instrument and ways in which composers/performers exploit it. They will be required to appraise their performance of it, showing an understanding of the composer's intentions and how far they have succeeded in communicating these, and to use the piece as the basis for developing a compositional brief.

The brief should reflect the candidate's understanding of the nature and characteristics of the chosen genre and allow the candidate to exploit the resource of their instrument. The composition will enable candidates not only to demonstrate understanding of the potential of their instrument, but also to select and explore further a range of stylistic features which they have come to understand through their study of three pieces.

Appraising the composition requires the candidate further to demonstrate critical judgment, evaluating their success in composing to their own brief and measuring the effectiveness of their composition against the background of their detailed knowledge of the three pieces in the same genre which they have studied.

The appraisals may either be written, or recorded, or both. Candidates will be expected to comment on the performance piece: how the instrument is exploited, the effectiveness of their performance and other aspects identified in the appraisal assessment criteria (7.4.3). The appraisal of the composition should be based on the brief developed from the candidate's understanding of identified features of the performance piece. The candidate should appraise the effectiveness of the composition in relation to the brief, how successfully the composition relates to other pieces within the chosen genre and other aspects identified in the appraisal criteria. The link between the performance piece and the composition must be made explicit. Candidates may also show their understanding of possible uses and effectiveness of ICT in these appraisals.

Use of ICT

Candidates may make use of ICT:

- as part of a performance (e.g. using distortion effects when playing the guitar);
- to enhance the performance (e.g. to add reverb to a recording);
- to facilitate the composing process (e.g. using a software programme to create and manipulate sounds);
- as a medium through which their composition is presented (e.g. multitracking different parts).